

# CONTOSO MUTUAL INSURANCE COMPANY

Licensed under the Department of Insurance · NAIC #84317

## Gold Shield

Comprehensive Health Insurance Policy

**Plan Code:** GS-HMO-2026

**Policy Number:** GS-2024-88811

**Effective Date:** 01 January 2026

**Policy Term:** 12 months (auto-renewable)

**Annual Premium:** \$5,640 per year

This Policy is a legal contract between the Insured and Contoso Mutual Insurance Company. Please read it carefully and retain it with your records. Coverage is provided in consideration of the application and the payment of premiums when due.

Underwritten and administered by Contoso Mutual Insurance Company

1200 Liberty Avenue, Suite 400, Wilmington, DE 19801 · [contoso-mutual.example](http://contoso-mutual.example)

## **Table of Contents**

- 1. Definitions .... page 3**
- 2. Schedule of Benefits .... page 4**
- 3. Deductibles, Co-payments and Out-of-pocket Maximum .... page 5**
- 4. Eligibility and Enrollment .... page 6**
- 5. Pre-existing Conditions .... page 7**
- 6. Exclusions and Limitations .... page 8**
- 7. Claims Procedure .... page 9**
- 8. Coordination of Benefits .... page 10**
- 9. Optional Riders .... page 11**
- 10. Regulatory Notices and Contact Information .... page 12**

## **Section 1: Definitions**

The following definitions apply throughout this Policy and any attached endorsements or riders:

### **1.1 Insured**

Any individual named in the Schedule of Benefits as a primary insured, spouse, or dependent child, who is enrolled under this Policy and for whom the applicable premium has been paid in full.

### **1.2 Insurer**

Contoso Mutual Insurance Company, the legal entity issuing this Policy. The Insurer shall not delegate its obligations under this contract without written notice to the Insured.

### **1.3 Deductible**

The dollar amount the Insured must pay out of pocket each policy year for Eligible Expenses before this Policy begins to pay benefits, except for Preventive Care services which are not subject to the Deductible.

### **1.4 Outpatient Treatment**

Medically necessary care, diagnostic services, surgery and follow-up rendered without requiring a continuous overnight admission to a hospital or other inpatient facility.

### **1.5 Eligible Expense**

A charge for a service or supply that is (a) medically necessary, (b) provided by a licensed provider, (c) not excluded by Section 6, and (d) within the Usual, Customary and Reasonable charge in the geographic area.

## Section 2: Schedule of Benefits

The annual benefit limits below apply per insured member per policy year under the Gold Shield plan. Amounts in excess of the listed limits are the responsibility of the Insured.

### 2.1 Annual Coverage Limits

**2.1.1 Inpatient Hospitalization (room, board, surgery).** Annual Limit: **\$250,000**. Member share after Deductible: 80% paid by Policy / 20% member co-payment.

**2.1.2 Outpatient Treatment (clinic, specialist, day surgery).** Annual Limit: **\$20,000 per policy year**. Member share after Deductible: 80% paid by Policy / 20% member co-payment.

**2.1.3 Diagnostic Imaging (MRI, CT, ultrasound, X-ray).** Annual Limit: **\$8,000**. Member share after Deductible: 80% paid by Policy / 20% member co-payment.

**2.1.4 Laboratory and Pathology.** Annual Limit: **\$10,000**. Member share after Deductible: 80% paid by Policy / 20% member co-payment.

**2.1.5 Prescription Medication (formulary).** Annual Limit: **\$5,000**. Member share after Deductible: 30% co-pay.

**2.1.6 Maternity and Newborn Care.** Annual Limit: **\$15,000**. Member share after Deductible: 80% paid by Policy / 20% member co-payment.

**2.1.7 Mental Health and Substance Use.** Annual Limit: **\$25,000**. Member share after Deductible: 80% paid by Policy / 20% member co-payment.

**2.1.8 Dental and Vision (basic).** Annual Limit: **\$1,500**. Member share after Deductible: 50% co-pay.

**2.1.9 Emergency Ambulance.** Annual Limit: **\$3,000 per event**. Member share after Deductible: 0% co-payment (after Deductible).

**2.1.10 Preventive Care (annual physical, vaccines).** Annual Limit: **100% covered**. Member share after Deductible: 0% co-payment (Deductible waived).

All limits reset on each policy anniversary. Unused benefit balances do not carry forward into the next policy year.

## Section 3: Deductibles, Co-payments and Out-of-pocket Maximum

### 3.1 Annual Deductible

The annual Deductible under the Gold Shield plan is **\$500 per insured member** per insured member. A family aggregate Deductible of twice the individual amount applies when two or more family members are covered. The Deductible accrues from Eligible Expenses incurred during the policy year and resets on the anniversary date.

### 3.2 Co-insurance

After the Deductible is satisfied, this Policy pays **80% paid by Policy / 20% member** of Eligible Expenses and the Insured pays the remainder, subject to the Out-of-pocket Maximum.

### 3.3 Out-of-pocket Maximum

The Out-of-pocket Maximum for the policy year is **\$6,000** per insured member. Once reached, this Policy pays 100% of Eligible Expenses for the remainder of the policy year. Premiums, non-covered services and amounts above Usual, Customary and Reasonable do not accrue toward this maximum.

### 3.4 Network Differential

Use of in-network providers (listed at [contoso-mutual.example/providers](http://contoso-mutual.example/providers)) is strongly recommended. Out-of-network services are subject to a 50% co-payment and balance billing by the provider.

## **Section 4: Eligibility and Enrollment**

Coverage is available to individuals aged 18 to 64 who are legal residents of the United States. Dependents include a legal spouse or domestic partner and unmarried children under age 26.

Open enrollment runs annually from November 1 through January 15. A Special Enrollment Period of 60 days applies following a qualifying life event such as marriage, birth or adoption of a child, involuntary loss of other coverage, or permanent relocation.

Coverage becomes effective on the first day of the calendar month following receipt of the completed enrollment application and the first premium payment. The Insurer may decline coverage if material misrepresentations are discovered during underwriting.

This Policy automatically renews each anniversary unless either party provides written notice of non-renewal at least 30 days before the renewal date.

## Section 5: Pre-existing Conditions

A **Pre-existing Condition** is any medical condition for which medical advice, diagnosis, care or treatment was recommended or received within the six-month period ending on the Insured's enrollment date.

Pre-existing Conditions are covered after a continuous waiting period of **12 months** from the policy start date, provided the condition was fully and accurately disclosed at enrollment. During the waiting period, treatment for the Pre-existing Condition is at the Insured's expense; the Insurer will pay 50% of Eligible Expenses for emergency care arising from the Pre-existing Condition even during the waiting period.

Conditions that are disclosed on the enrollment application and accepted by the Insurer in writing are deemed not to be Pre-existing Conditions for the purposes of this Section.

Pregnancy in progress at the effective date of coverage is not considered a Pre-existing Condition. Newborn and adopted children added under Special Enrollment are likewise exempt.

## **Section 6: Exclusions and Limitations**

The following services, supplies and conditions are not covered under this Policy, except where specifically mandated by applicable law:

- 6.1** Cosmetic surgery, including non-reconstructive plastic surgery and elective dermatological procedures.
- 6.2** Experimental, investigational or unproven treatments not approved by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration for the condition being treated.
- 6.3** Injuries sustained while participating in professional or semi-professional athletic competition.
- 6.4** Self-inflicted injuries, except where resulting from a documented mental health condition covered under Section 2.
- 6.5** Services rendered by an immediate family member of the Insured.
- 6.6** Custodial care, long-term skilled nursing facility stays exceeding 100 days per policy year, and personal convenience items.
- 6.7** War, declared or undeclared, and acts of terrorism in jurisdictions where the Insured is not lawfully present.
- 6.8** Treatment of obesity unless meeting medical-necessity criteria for bariatric intervention as defined by the American Society for Metabolic and Bariatric Surgery.



## Section 7: Claims Procedure

**7.1** Claims for benefits under this Policy must be submitted within **90 days** of the date of service. Late submissions are reviewed at the Insurer's discretion and may be denied except where the Insured can demonstrate that timely submission was not reasonably possible.

**7.2** All claims shall be submitted on Contoso claim form **CF-102** accompanied by (a) itemized invoices showing CPT or HCPCS codes, (b) a copy of the Insured's identification card, and (c) any supporting medical reports.

**7.3** The Insurer will issue an Explanation of Benefits within 10 business days of receipt of a complete claim and reimburse approved Eligible Expenses within 15 business days thereafter. Direct payment to participating providers is the default; reimbursement to the Insured applies where care was rendered out of network.

**7.4** Pre-authorization is required for non-emergency inpatient admissions, surgeries scheduled more than 72 hours in advance, advanced imaging (MRI, CT, PET) and durable medical equipment over \$1,000. Failure to obtain pre-authorization may result in a 25% benefit reduction.

**7.5** Disputed claims may be appealed in writing within 180 days of the Explanation of Benefits. Final disputes are subject to binding arbitration administered by the American Arbitration Association.

## **Section 8: Coordination of Benefits**

When the Insured is covered by more than one health benefit plan, this Policy coordinates benefits to ensure total reimbursement does not exceed 100% of Eligible Expenses. Order of benefit determination follows the rules promulgated by the National Association of Insurance Commissioners.

Where this Policy is the primary plan, benefits are paid as if no other coverage exists. Where it is the secondary plan, benefits are reduced by amounts payable under the primary plan. The Insured must report all other coverages at enrollment and within 30 days of any change.

Subrogation: where a third party is legally liable for an injury or illness, the Insurer is subrogated to the Insured's right of recovery up to the amount of benefits paid under this Policy.

## **Section 9: Optional Riders**

The following riders may be added at any policy anniversary, subject to additional premium and underwriting:

### **9.1 Critical Illness Rider**

Lump-sum cash benefit of \$50,000 payable on first diagnosis of cancer, myocardial infarction, stroke, end-stage renal failure or major organ transplant. 90-day waiting period applies from rider effective date.

### **9.2 Hospital Cash Rider**

\$200 per night of inpatient admission, payable from the second night onward, up to 90 nights per policy year. Paid in addition to Section 2 Inpatient Hospitalization benefits.

### **9.3 International Travel Rider**

Extends emergency and urgent care coverage to incidents occurring outside the United States for trips up to 90 consecutive days. Excludes scheduled treatment sought abroad as 'medical tourism.'

## Section 10: Regulatory Notices and Contact Information

**10.1 State Mandates.** This Policy complies with the minimum benefit and consumer-protection standards of the state of issuance. Where state law requires broader benefits, those provisions apply notwithstanding any narrower language in this Policy.

**10.2 Non-discrimination.** The Insurer does not deny, limit, condition or terminate coverage on the basis of race, color, national origin, age, disability, sex or gender identity.

**10.3 Free-look Period.** The Insured may cancel this Policy within 30 days of receipt for a full refund of premium, less any claims paid.

### Contact Information

**Member Services:** 1-800-555-0150 · [members@contoso-mutual.example](mailto:members@contoso-mutual.example)

**Claims Inquiries:** 1-800-555-0142 · [claims@contoso-mutual.example](mailto:claims@contoso-mutual.example)

**Pre-authorization:** 1-800-555-0185 · [preauth@contoso-mutual.example](mailto:preauth@contoso-mutual.example)

**Mailing Address:** Contoso Mutual Insurance, PO Box 12001, Wilmington DE 19801

**Online Portal:** [members.contoso-mutual.example](https://members.contoso-mutual.example)

Signed for and on behalf of Contoso Mutual Insurance Company:

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Dr. Eleanor Whitfield, Chief Underwriting Officer    Marcus T. Vance, Corporate Secretary